



Pedigree analysis: One teaching strategy to incorporate genetics into a full FNP program

Gretchen Schumacher ^{a,*}, Alice E. Conway ^{b,1}, Judith A. Sparlin ^{c,2}

^a *Nursing Faculty/Slippery Rock University, Clarion/Edinboro/Slippery Rock Universities Master of Science in Nursing and Family Nurse Practitioner Program, 115B Strain Building, Slippery Rock, PA 16057, United States*

^b *Department of Nursing, Clarion/Edinboro/Slippery Rock Universities Master of Science in Nursing and Family, Nurse Practitioner Program, Edinboro, PA 16444, United States*

^c *Graduate Faculty, Clarion University, Clarion/Edinboro/Slippery Rock Universities Master of Science in Nursing and Family Nurse Practitioner Program, 311 Belladonna Drive, Glenshaw, PA 15116, United States*

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Summary The successful completion of the genome project in April 2003 and explosion of genetic knowledge is impacting healthcare at a dramatic rate. All healthcare providers need to update themselves on genetics in order to provide comprehensive care. This article describes a national grant obtained to educate faculty regarding incorporating genetics into courses. It also presents an innovative method for incorporating genetics into a full Family Nurse Practitioner (FNP) curriculum. Student responses and guidelines for one assignment are included. Utilizing this type of assignment in FNP courses is beneficial to both students and faculty. With more FNPs assessing patterns for illness in families, primary prevention and earlier intervention in primary care can be achieved.

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Introduction

On April 14, 2003 The National Genome Research Institute (NHGRI), part of the National Institutes

of Health (NIH), the Department of Energy (DOE), and their partners in the International Human Sequencing Consortium announced the successful completion of the Human Genome Project (HGP). The HGP was the international, collaborative program whose goal was the complete mapping and understanding of all the genes of human beings. All our genes together are known as our "genome". The international research centers that collaborated with the United States were located in

* Corresponding author. Tel.: +1 724 738 4916; fax: +1 724 738 2509.

E-mail addresses: g4him@direcway.com, aconway@edinboro.edu, jsparlin@clarion.edu.

¹ Tel.: +1 814 732 2285; fax: +1 814 732 2536.

² Tel.: +1 412 487 4399.